information in the source document when returning it to the client? We can manipulate the responses based on our requirements, as we discuss in the next section.

5.3 Manipulating responses

The response returned to the client can contain a lot of information, and the client may not be interested in receiving all of it. And sometimes there may be sensitive information that must not be exposed in the source sent back as the response. Also, sending a huge amount of data as a response (if the source has 500 attributes, for example) is a waste of bandwidth! There are ways to manipulate responses before sending them to the client. First, let's fetch the source of the document without metadata.

5.3.1 Removing metadata from the response

Usually, the response object consists of metadata and the original document (the source). The notable attribute in the response is the `_source` attribute, which encompasses the original input document. We can fetch just the source (original document) without the metadata by issuing the query like this:

```
GET <index_name>/_source/<id>
```

Notice that the `_doc` endpoint is replaced with `_source`; everything else in the invocation stays the same. Let's get the `movie` document by using this `_source` endpoint.

Listing 5.12 Fetching the original document with no metadata

```
GET movies/_source/1
```

As the response in figure 5.9 indicates, the document we indexed is returned with no additional information. There are no metadata fields like `_version`, `_id`, or `_index`; there's just the original source document.

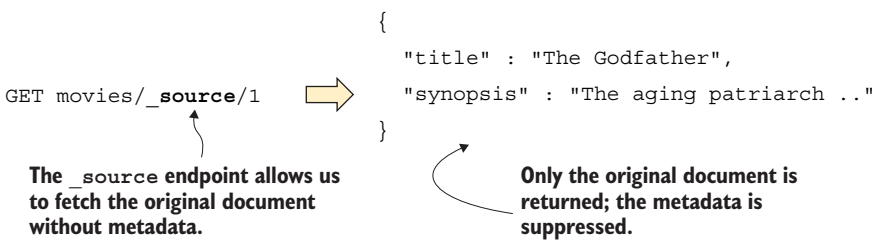


Figure 5.9 The `_source` endpoint returns the original document with no metadata.

What if we want to get the metadata but not the source document? Sure, we can do that too. Let's look at how we can suppress the source data.